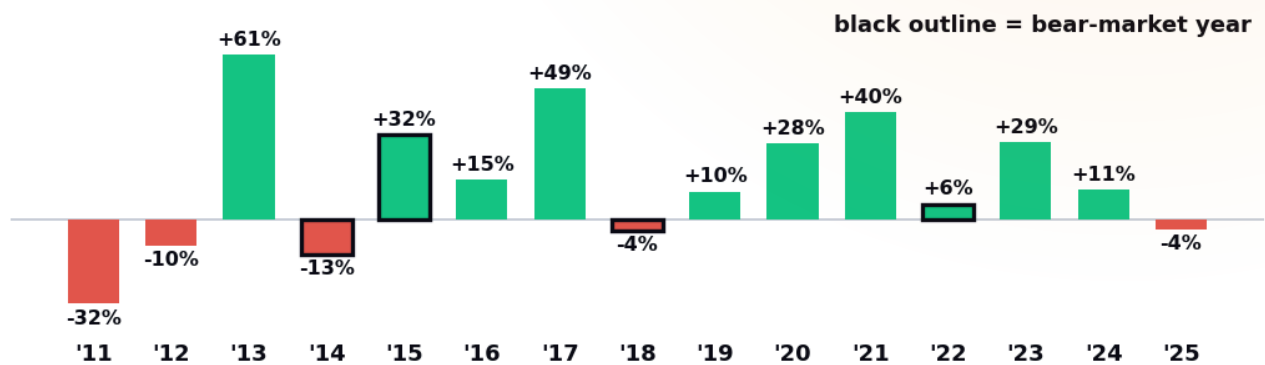


THE UPTOBER STUDY

Every Bitcoin October since 2011, first open to last close, against every other month of the year. 15 Octobers.

Bull years against bear years, what a green September led to, the dips hiding inside the good Octobers, and where October 2026 starts.



every Bitcoin October since 2011, first open to last close. Bitstamp.

10 of 15

Octobers closed higher,
median +11%

2 of 4

bear-year Octobers closed
higher, median +0.5%

5 of 6

green Septembers were
followed by a green fourth
quarter

Educational, not financial advice. Fifteen Octobers is fifteen data points, and four of them were in bear markets. Seasonality is the weakest kind of edge, and the tables show why.



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THE RULE

HOW A MONTH WAS MEASURED

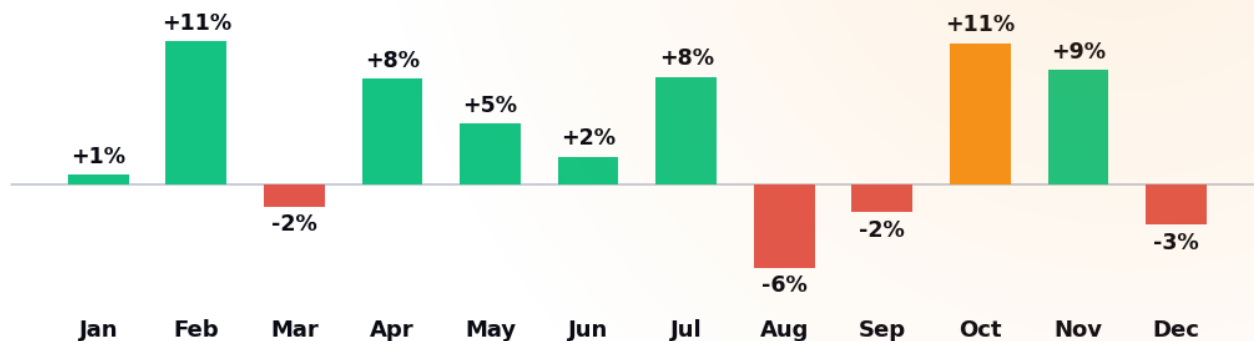
The month. The first daily open of the calendar month to the last daily close, on Bitstamp BTC/USD from October 2011. **The dip.** The lowest daily wick inside the month against the month's open. **The quarter.** The October open to the December close.

Bull and bear years. The calendar years used in every September study on this page. Bear years are 2014, 2015, 2018 and 2022, and 2026 would be the fifth. Every other year from 2011 to 2025 is a bull year. It is a crude split and it cannot be tuned after the fact.

The baseline. All 179 months from October 2011 to August 2026. The median month was +3.1%, higher 56% of the time.

EVERY MONTH

OCTOBER IS THE **SECOND-BEST** MONTH



median Bitcoin return by calendar month, 2011 to 2026. 14 to 15 of each month.

MONTH	N	MEDIAN	MEAN	HIGHER	RANK BY MEDIAN
January	15	+0.7%	+4.4%	8 of 15	8
February	15	+11.1%	+9.7%	10 of 15	1
March	15	-1.8%	+11.6%	7 of 15	9
April	15	+8.1%	+11.3%	10 of 15	5
May	15	+4.7%	+9.0%	8 of 15	6
June	15	+2.1%	-0.1%	8 of 15	7
July	15	+8.3%	+9.9%	11 of 15	4
August	15	-6.5%	+3.2%	6 of 15	12
September	14	-2.2%	-1.4%	6 of 14	10
October	15	+10.9%	+14.4%	10 of 15	2
November	15	+8.8%	+36.4%	9 of 15	3
December	15	-3.2%	+6.2%	7 of 15	11

2011 to 2026. September 2026 is not included.

October's median of +10.9% ranks second, a hair behind February. Its mean of +14.4% is pulled up by 2013 and 2017. August and September are the two weakest months by median, which is where the 'weak September, strong October' story comes from.

EVERY OCTOBER ALL 15 OCTOBERS

YEAR	OCTOBER	WORST DIP INSIDE	SEPTEMBER BEFORE	Q4 (OCT TO DEC)	REGIME
2011	-32%	-54%		-5%	bull
2012	-10%	-22%	+20%	+8%	bull
2013	+61%	-33%	-1%	+480%	bull
2014	-13%	-29%	-18%	-18%	bear
2015	+32%	-0%	+3%	+83%	bear
2016	+15%	-1%	+7%	+59%	bull
2017	+49%	-4%	-9%	+221%	bull
2018	-4%	-8%	-6%	-44%	bear
2019	+10%	-12%	-13%	-14%	bull
2020	+28%	-4%	-8%	+169%	bull
2021	+40%	-1%	-7%	+5%	bull
2022	+6%	-6%	-3%	-15%	bear
2023	+29%	-2%	+4%	+57%	bull
2024	+11%	-7%	+7%	+47%	bull
2025	-4%	-9%	+5%	-23%	bull

Worst dip on daily wicks against the October open. 2011 has no September on Bitstamp.

Five Octobers closed red, 2011, 2012, 2014, 2018 and 2025. Three of those five came in bear years or in the first month of one. October 2025 is the most recent, and the most instructive. Bitcoin made its all-time high of \$126,272 on 6 October 2025 and the month still closed down 4%, the first month of the bear.

THE SPLITS

THE YEAR AND THE **SEPTEMBER** BEFORE IT

GROUP	N	OCTOBER MEDIAN	HIGHER	TYPICAL DIP	Q4 MEDIAN	Q4 HIGHER
All Octobers	15	+10.9%	10 of 15	-7%	+8.4%	9 of 15
Bull years	11	+14.6%	8 of 11	-7%	+47.4%	8 of 11
Bear years	4	+0.5%	2 of 4	-7%	-16.2%	1 of 4
After a green September	6	+12.7%	4 of 6	-4%	+52.1%	5 of 6
After a red September	8	+19.2%	6 of 8	-7%	-4.1%	4 of 8

Medians. Q4 = October open to December close.

In bull years October was +15% and higher 8 of 11 times, and the quarter after was +47%. In bear years it was +0.5% and higher 2 of 4, and the quarter was -16%. The month looked the same on the calendar and gave opposite answers depending on the year around it.

The September split matters more for the quarter than for the month. After a red September, October itself did well, but the quarter was a coin flip. After a green September, the quarter was higher 5 of 6 times. Six and eight cases each, so a lean, not a rule.

THE DIPS

UPTOBER NEVER MEANT STRAIGHT UP

The typical October had a 7% dip inside it on the wicks, measured from the month's open. October 2013 fell 33% inside the month and still closed up 61%. October 2011 fell 54% and closed down 32%. Even in the good years, the month came with a pullback somewhere in it.

That matters for anyone who trades the calendar. A green October has usually meant holding through a red week or two, not buying on the 1st and watching it rise.

OCTOBER 2026

WHERE THIS OCTOBER STARTS

September 2026 opened at \$78,571 and was up about 6% with two days left, on track for the fourth green September in a row after 2023, 2024 and 2025. The month included the first daily and weekly closes above \$82,833, the last lower high of this bear, since January.

The calendar puts 2026 in the bear-year group, where October has been a coin flip. The structure break puts a question mark on that label. If this is still a bear year, the record says October is a coin flip. If the break was the turn, the bull-year and green-September rows apply.

THE READ

Uptober is real on average and weak in bear markets. The month does not decide it. The year does.

WHAT THIS STUDY DOES NOT SAY

Fifteen Octobers. Seasonality on fifteen data points is a lean at best. Two big years, 2013 and 2017, move the average a lot, which is why this guide uses medians.

Four bear-year Octobers. The bear-year row is the most useful one for 2026 and the smallest.

Calendar months are arbitrary. Nothing special happens to Bitcoin at midnight on 1 October. A month is a window, and a slightly different window gives slightly different numbers.

Everyone knows about Uptober. A pattern this famous is the kind most likely to fade, because people trade it early.

Data pinned 28 September 2026. Bitstamp BTC/USD daily bars from October 2011. Scripts: Uptober/up_study.py, up_charts.py. This is education, not financial advice.

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